

Customization Guide

DocsForge provides powerful customization options beyond the basic configuration. This guide covers advanced techniques for tailoring your site's appearance, behavior, and functionality.

Custom CSS

Add custom stylesheets via the `extra_css` setting in `docsforge.yml`:

```
extra_css:
  - stylesheets/extra.css
```

Create `docs/stylesheets/extra.css`:

```
/* Custom brand color */
:root {
  --md-primary-fg-color: #4051b5;
  --md-primary-fg-color--light: #5d6cc0;
  --md-primary-fg-color--dark: #2e3b8e;
}

/* Custom font for headings */
.md-typeset h1,
.md-typeset h2 {
  font-family: 'Georgia', serif;
  font-weight: 700;
}

/* Wider content area */
@media screen and (min-width: 76.25em) {
  .md-content {
    max-width: 900px;
  }
}
```

Overriding theme variables

DocsForge uses CSS custom properties for theming. Override them in your custom CSS:

Variable	Description
<code>--md-primary-fg-color</code>	Primary color

Variable	Description
<code>--md-primary-fg-color--light</code>	Light variant
<code>--md-primary-fg-color--dark</code>	Dark variant
<code>--md-accent-fg-color</code>	Accent color
<code>--md-typeset-color</code>	Body text color
<code>--md-typeset-a-color</code>	Link color
<code>--md-code-fg-color</code>	Code text color
<code>--md-code-bg-color</code>	Code background
<code>--md-default-fg-color</code>	Default foreground
<code>--md-default-bg-color</code>	Default background

Custom JavaScript

Add custom scripts via `extra_javascript`:

```
extra_javascript:  
  - javascripts/extra.js
```

Create `docs/javascripts/extra.js`:

```
// Custom behavior on page load  
document.addEventListener('DOMContentLoaded', function() {  
  // Add copy button to all tables  
  const tables = document.querySelectorAll('.md-typeset table');  
  tables.forEach(table => {  
    const button = document.createElement('button');  
    button.className = 'md-clipboard';  
    button.innerHTML = 'Copy';  
    button.addEventListener('click', () => {  
      navigator.clipboard.writeText(table.innerText);  
    });  
    table.parentElement.insertBefore(button, table);  
  });  
});
```

Hooking into DocsForge events

```
// Listen for search events
window.addEventListener('docsforge-search', function(e) {
  console.log('Search query:', e.detail.query);
});

// Listen for theme changes
window.addEventListener('docsforge-theme', function(e) {
  console.log('Theme changed to:', e.detail.scheme);
});
```

Custom Templates

Override built-in templates by creating an `overrides` directory and referencing it in `docsforge.yml`:

```
theme:
  custom_dir: overrides
```

Override partials

Create `docs/overrides/partials/copyright.html`:

```
<!-- Custom copyright notice -->
<div class="md-copyright">
  <strong>My Company</strong> -
  <a href="{{ config.repo_url }}" target="_blank" rel="noopener">
    {{ config.repo_name }}
  </a>
</div>
```

Override base template

Create `docs/overrides/main.html` to extend the base template:

```
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block extrahead %}
  {{ super() }}
  <meta property="og:image" content="{{ config.site_url }}assets/social-
card.png">
{% endblock %}

{% block announce %}
  <div class="announcement">
    🎉 New version released! <a href="/changelog">See what's new</a>
  </div>
{% endblock %}
```

```
</div>
{% endblock %}
```

Available blocks

Block	Description
<code>extrahead</code>	Inside <code><head></code> tag
<code>announce</code>	Announcement banner
<code>header</code>	Site header
<code>tabs</code>	Navigation tabs
<code>content</code>	Main content area
<code>footer</code>	Page footer
<code>outdated</code>	Outdated version notice

Custom Admonitions

Define custom admonition types with CSS:

```
/* Custom "tip" admonition in brand color */
.md-typeset .admonition.tip {
  border-color: #4051b5;
}

.md-typeset .admonition.tip > .admonition-title {
  background-color: rgba(64, 81, 181, 0.1);
  color: #4051b5;
}

.md-typeset .admonition.tip > .admonition-title::before {
  background-color: #4051b5;
  -webkit-mask-image: url('data:image/svg+xml;charset=utf-8,<svg
xmlns="http://www.w3.org/2000/svg" viewBox="0 0 24 24"><path d="M12 2C6.48 2 2
6.48 2 12s4.48 10 10 10 4.48 10-10S17.52 2 12 2zm-2 15l-5-5 1.41-1.41L10
14.17l7.59-7.59L19 8l-9 9z"/></svg>');
  mask-image: url('data:image/svg+xml;charset=utf-8,<svg
xmlns="http://www.w3.org/2000/svg" viewBox="0 0 24 24"><path d="M12 2C6.48 2 2
6.48 2 12s4.48 10 10 10 4.48 10-10S17.52 2 12 2zm-2 15l-5-5 1.41-1.41L10
```

```
14.1717.59-7.59L19 81-9 9z"/></svg>');  
}
```

Usage in Markdown:

```
!!! tip "Custom Tip"  
    This uses your brand color!
```

Custom Icons and Logos

SVG logo

Use an SVG for crisp rendering at any size:

```
theme:  
  logo: assets/logo.svg
```

The SVG should be optimized and have `viewBox` for proper scaling.

Custom icon definitions

Define custom icons in `extra.css`:

```
.md-icon--custom::after {  
  content: "";  
  display: inline-block;  
  width: 1em;  
  height: 1em;  
  background-image: url("assets/custom-icon.svg");  
  background-size: contain;  
  vertical-align: middle;  
}
```

Custom Fonts

Self-hosted fonts

Place font files in `docs/assets/fonts/` and define them in CSS:

```
@font-face {  
  font-family: 'CustomFont';  
  src: url('../assets/fonts/CustomFont.woff2') format('woff2');  
  font-weight: 400;  
  font-style: normal;
```

```
font-display: swap;
}

:root {
  --md-text-font: 'CustomFont', 'Roboto', sans-serif;
}
```

Custom 404 Page

Create `docs/overrides/404.html`:

```
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block content %}
  <div class="md-content__inner">
    <h1>404 – Page Not Found</h1>
    <p>The page you requested doesn't exist.</p>
    <a href="{ nav.homepage.url | url }" class="md-button md-button--primary">
      Go Home
    </a>
  </div>
{% endblock %}
```

Performance Tuning

Lazy loading images

Images are lazy-loaded by default. For above-the-fold images, use `loading="eager"`:

```
![[Hero image]](hero.png){ loading=eager }
```

Image optimization

Optimize images before adding them to `docs/`:

```
# Convert to WebP for smaller size
ffmpeg -i image.png image.webp

# Or use ImageMagick
convert image.png -quality 85 image.webp
```

Preload critical resources

```
{% block extrahead %}
  {{ super() }}
  <link rel="preload" href="{ 'assets/fonts/CustomFont.woff2' | url }}"
  as="font" type="font/woff2" crossorigin>
{% endblock %}
```

Accessibility

Color contrast

Ensure your custom colors meet WCAG AA standards (4.5:1 for normal text, 3:1 for large text).
Test with a [contrast checker](#).

Keyboard navigation

DocsForge supports keyboard navigation out of the box. Custom interactive elements should handle `Tab`, `Enter`, and `Escape` keys.

ARIA labels

```
<button class="md-button" aria-label="Close announcement">
  <span class="md-icon">close</span>
</button>
```

Multi-language Sites

DocsForge does not include a built-in internationalization plugin. You have two practical options:

Option 1: Build separate sites per language

Maintain a `docsforge.yml` for each language and build them independently:

```
docs/
├── en/
│   └── index.md
├── de/
│   └── index.md
└── fr/
    └── index.md
```

Use a small build script to output each language to a separate subdirectory.

Option 2: Use a third-party i18n plugin

Install an MkDocs-compatible i18n plugin and declare it under `plugins:`:

```
plugins:
- i18n:
    languages:
    - locale: en
      name: English
      default: true
    - locale: de
      name: Deutsch
    - locale: fr
      name: Français
```

Compatibility

Third-party MkDocs plugins may need to be adapted for DocsForge. Test thoroughly before relying on them in production.

Analytics Integration

Google Analytics 4

```
extra:
  analytics:
    provider: google
    property: G-XXXXXXXXXX
```

Plausible

```
extra:
  analytics:
    provider: plausible
    property: docs.example.com
```

Custom analytics

```
{% block extrahead %}
  {{ super() }}
  <script async src="https://analytics.example.com/script.js" data-
site="YOUR_SITE_ID"></script>
{% endblock %}
```

Social Cards

DocsForge does not auto-generate social card images, but it does set basic OpenGraph tags. For a custom card image, add it manually in a template override:

```
{% block extrahead %}
    {{ super() }}
    <meta property="og:title" content="{{ page.title | default(config.site_name)
    }}">
    <meta property="og:description" content="{{ page.meta.description |
    default(config.site_description) }}">
    <meta property="og:image" content="{{ config.site_url }}assets/social-
    card.png">
    <meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image">
{% endblock %}
```

Build Hooks

`hooks` are Python modules that act like mini-plugins. Each file listed under `hooks:` is imported and can implement `on_pre_build` and/or `on_post_build` events.

```
hooks:
- scripts/hooks.py
```

Create `docs/scripts/hooks.py`:

```
import os

def on_pre_build(*, config):
    """Run before DocsForge starts building pages."""
    print("Pre-build hook running...")

def on_post_build(*, config):
    """Run after DocsForge has written the site directory."""
    print(f"Site built at: {config.site_dir}")
```



Shell scripts

If you need to run a shell command, invoke it from the Python hook with

```
subprocess.run(["..."])
```

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